

HENRY MELLER

Meller Posts the Best Round in TEG History

A quadruple-bogey nine at the par-five 8th should have ended it; instead he played the closing nine in ten shots to par and set a personal-best gross into the bargain.

Henry Meller opened TEG 1 at Praia D'El Rey with a round of -13. It remains the best round in TEG history to date. The gross figure was +12, a personal best, and the front nine did not hint at any of it. Three pars to open, at the 1st, 2nd and 3rd. Then a double bogey at the 4th. Then the 8th, the hardest hole on the course, where he signed for a quadruple bogey nine.

That is normally the end of a card. Meller simply declined to acknowledge it. From the 10th to the 18th he gained ten shots against par. Five holes in a row, the 10th through the 14th, passed without a single gross shot dropped. He closed with two bogeys, at the 15th and the 18th, either side of pars that caused nobody any concern. The nine at the 8th survives as the round's only blemish, a small disaster swallowed whole by the calm on either side of it.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY
Henry MELLER (-13)

TROPHY LEAD
Henry MELLER, 3 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD
Jon BAKER, 1 ahead

ROUND NET VP
HM -13 | JB -10 | GW -7 | DM -3 | SN -3 | AB +1
ROUND GROSS
JB +11 | HM +12 | DM +16 | SN +20 | GW +25 | AB +37

AFTER R1 • TROPHY
HM -13 | JB -10 | GW -7 | DM -3 | SN -3 | AB +1
AFTER R1 • GREEN JACKET
JB +11 | HM +12 | DM +16 | SN +20 | GW +25 | AB +37

GREEN JACKET

Jon Baker's Record Gross Leads the Jacket

He made a quadruple-bogey seven at the 2nd and still shot the lowest gross round in TEG history, which buys him a one-shot Jacket lead and precisely nothing in the Trophy.

Jon Baker opened TEG 7 at Praia D'El Rey with a gross round of +11, the best gross round in TEG history to date. It was not achieved without incident. At the short 2nd, stroke index 13 and one of the easier holes on the card, he made a quadruple bogey seven. Early, ugly, and apparently of no lasting interest to him. He

recovered to card a net -10, the third-best round in TEG history, and finished with three straight pars from the 16th that cost him nothing gross or net.

Those three pars decided things. On the 10th he had drawn level for the Trophy lead, and by the 12th he had drawn level for the Green Jacket, only

for Henry Meller to reclaim the outright Jacket lead moments later at the 2nd. By the close Baker held the Green Jacket lead by a single stroke. Meller topped the Trophy, three clear of him. Two men, two competitions, one afternoon, and no agreement between them.

ALEX BAKER

Alex Baker's Debut Measured in Eights

Three eights, one of them a quintuple bogey at a par three, and bottom of the Spoon race with seventeen holes still to play on his first day.

Alex Baker's first round of TEG golf, on debut at Praia D'El Rey, was an education. He began in reasonable order, shipping three bogeys through holes 2 to 4. Then he reached the par-3 5th and took a quintuple bogey 8. On a card that eventually contained a great deal, it still stands out.

It got worse, and it got worse methodically. Holes 8 through 11 cost him 11 shots, a quadruple bogey at the 10th among them. A second quadruple arrived at the 14th, one of the harder holes on the course, and with it last place in the TEG 7 Wooden Spoon race. He did not leave it again that day. The stretch from 14 to 16 removed a further eight shots. Three separate eights on the scorecard, on a course he had never seen before. Few men have introduced themselves to TEG so thoroughly.

PRAIA D'EL REY

Praia D'El Rey Sorts the Field

Nobody in the field had seen the place before, and the dunes on the back nine collected an eight from four of the six men who walked them.

Praia D'El Rey made its TEG debut on Thursday 2 October 2014, and showed the six-man field both its links teeth and its parkland manners in a single afternoon. David Mullin took a quadruple bogey 8 at the 18th, one of the course's harder holes. Gregg Williams matched him with a quadruple at the 6th, then composed himself admirably. Two four-hole stretches, at 7-10 and 13-16, passed with nothing worse than a bogey, and carried him level with Mullin for the Trophy lead by the 10th. Stuart Neumann fared less well, triple-bogeying the 3rd and the 7th and sinking to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon race. Nobody in the field had ever played the place. That made the day's extremes into records by default: the best score finished 11 over par, the worst 37 over, and both went straight onto the books.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 7, Round 1

TEG RECORDS

- Jon Baker's +11 (gross) is the best Gross round in TEG history to date
- Henry Meller's -13 is the best round in TEG history to date
- Jon Baker's -10 is the 3rd-best round in TEG history to date

PERSONAL BESTS

- Henry Meller posts a personal-best Gross round: +12
- Henry Meller — +2 Gross on the Back nine is a personal-best Back nine Gross
- Henry Meller — -10 net-vs-par on the Back nine is a personal-best Back nine net-vs-par

RARE FEATS

- Alex Baker runs up an 8 (+5) at the 5th — his career-worst on a par-3